

Bayesian Graphical Modeling

Theory

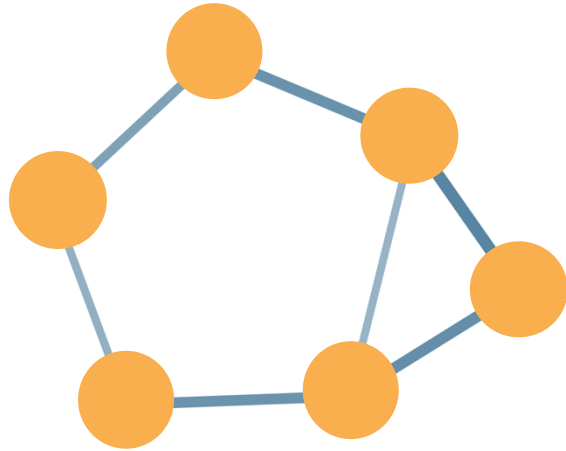
PsyNets Winterschool 2026

m.marsman@uva.nl

bayesiangraphicalmodeling.com

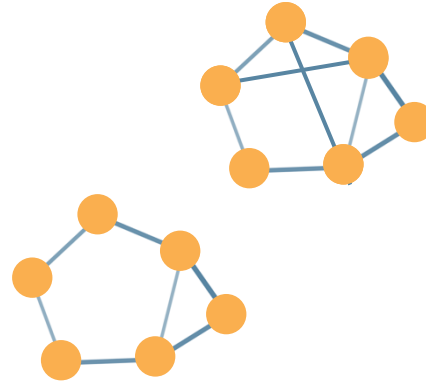


Setup Today



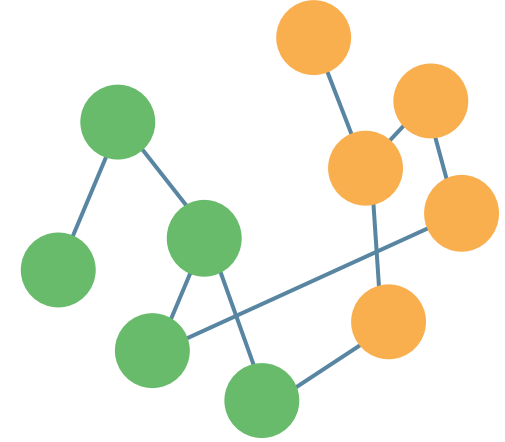
Estimating & Testing

Morning Session



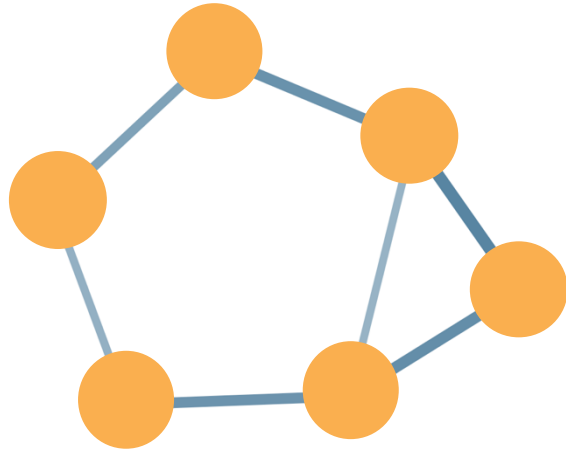
Network Comparison

Afternoon Session



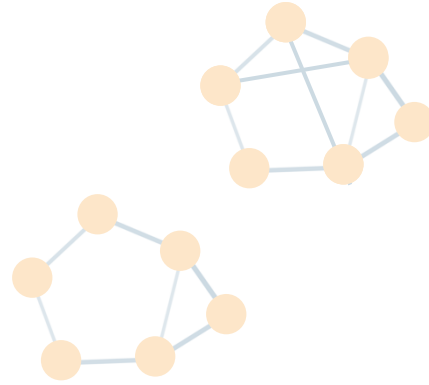
Clustering

Setup Today



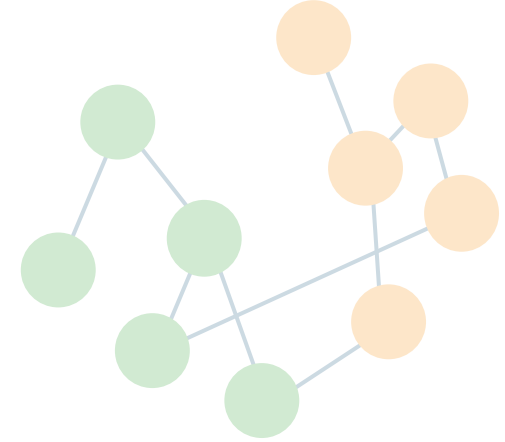
Estimating & Testing

Morning Session



Network Comparison

Afternoon Session



Clustering

Session setup



Part I: Theory



Part II: Practical



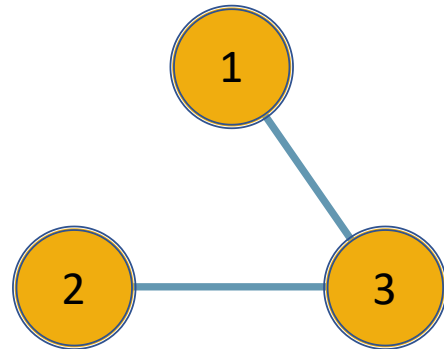
Part III: Project

Session setup



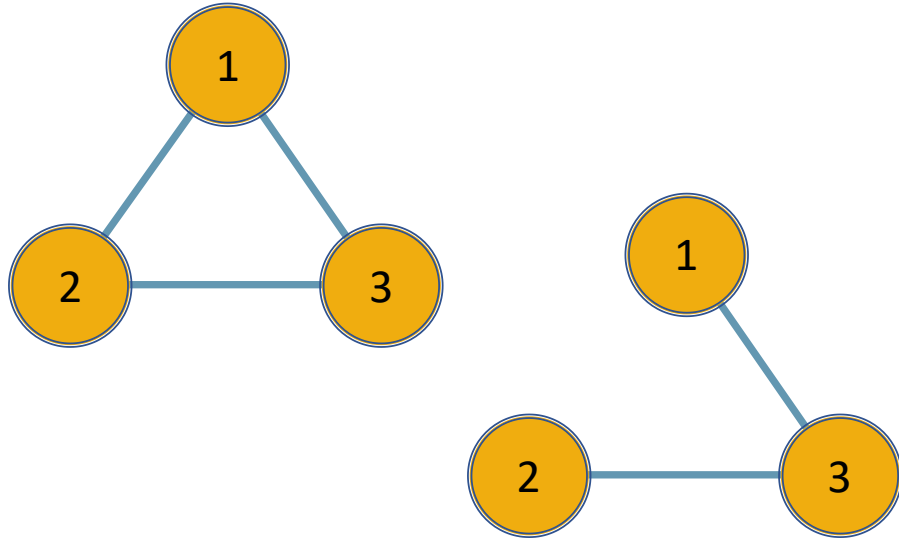
Part I: Theory

Two fundamental questions in network analysis



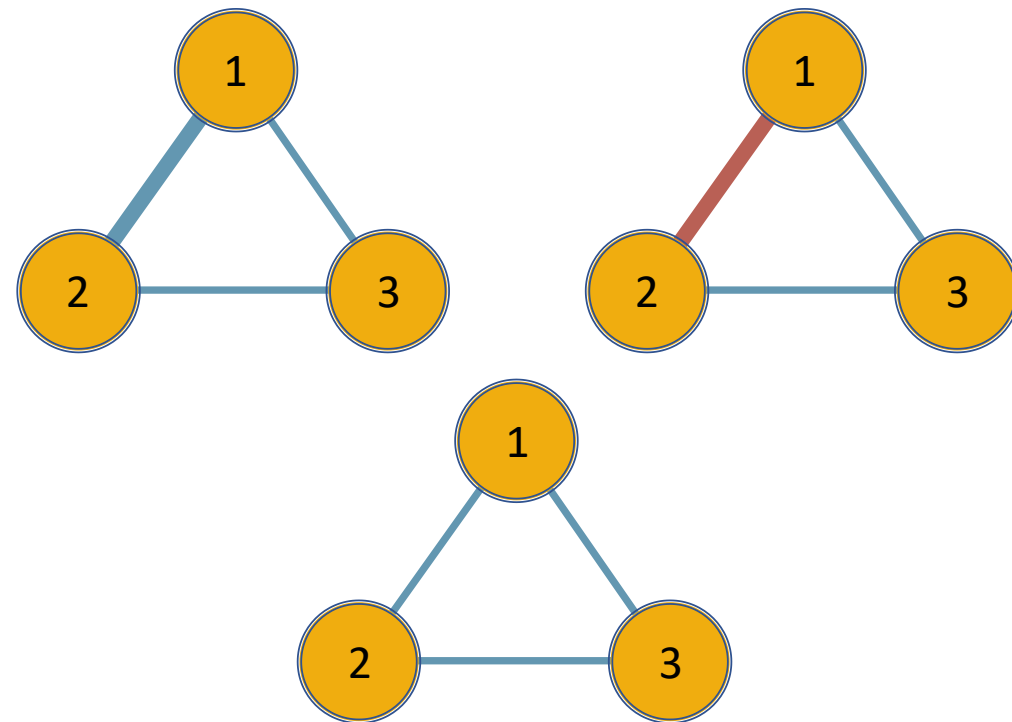
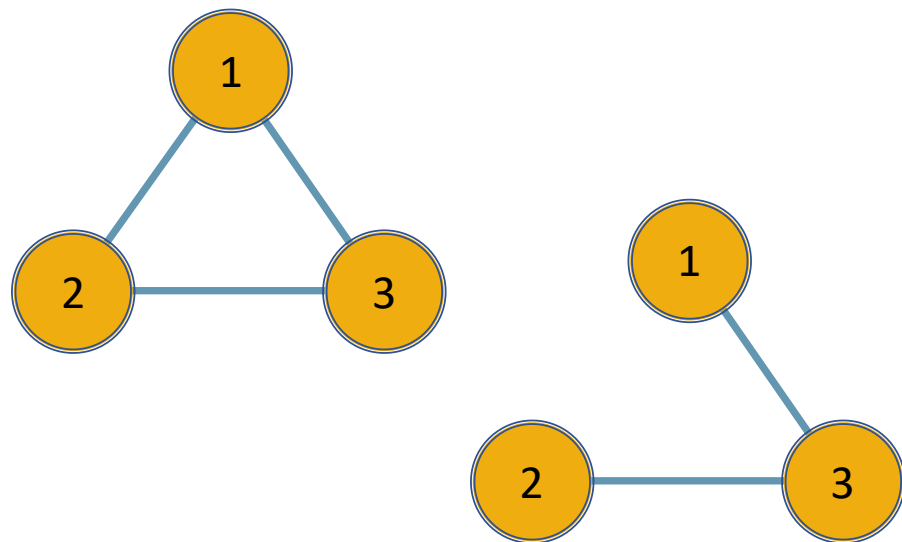
Two fundamental questions in network analysis

Is there an effect?



Two fundamental questions in network analysis

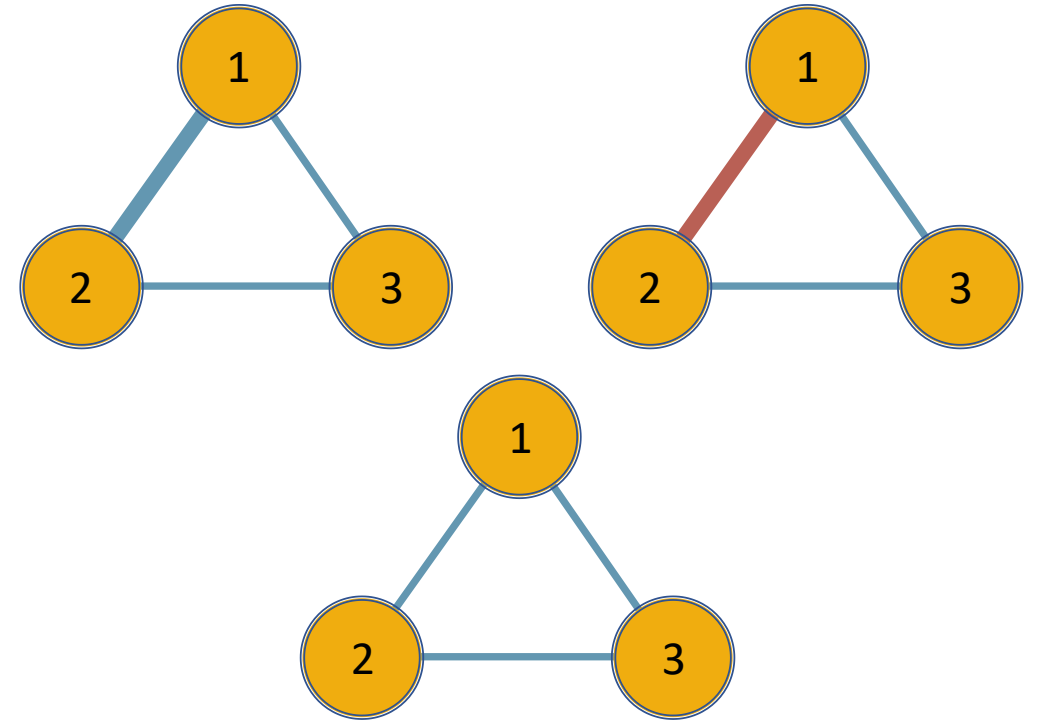
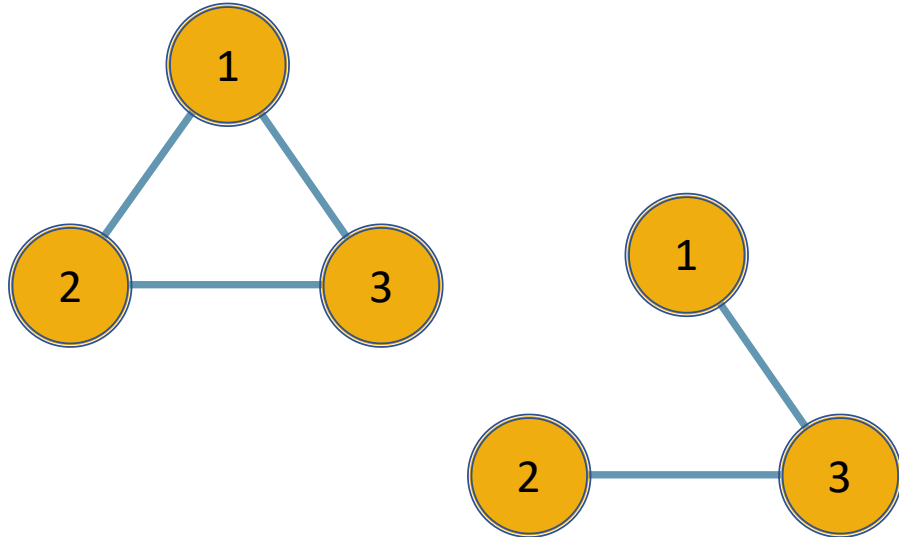
Is there an effect?



What is the effect?

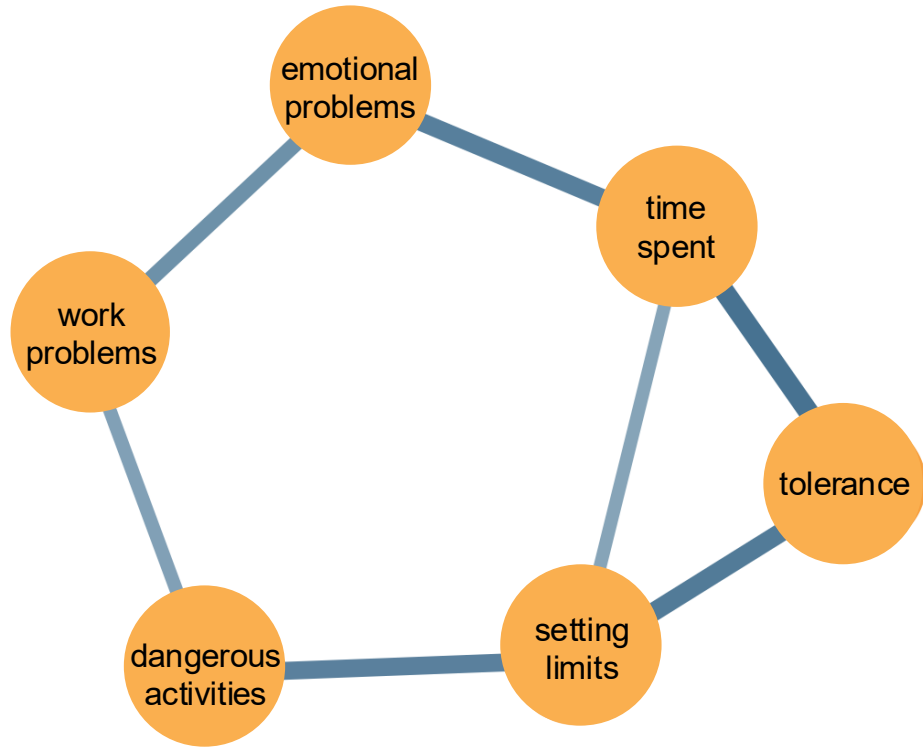
Two fundamental questions in network analysis

Is there an effect?

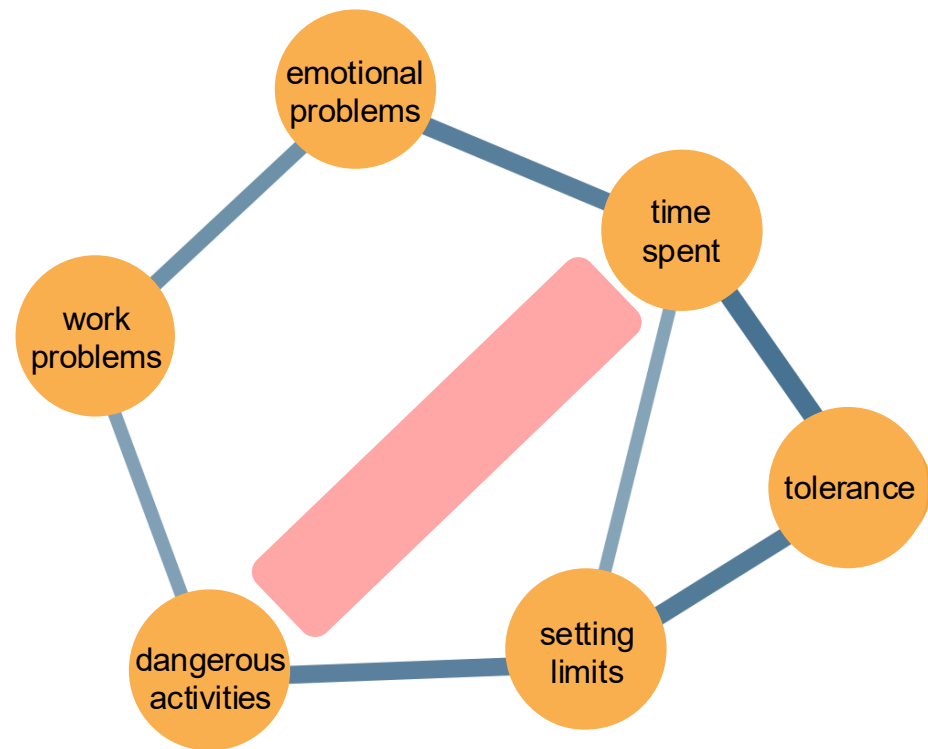


What is the effect?

A network of alcohol disorder symptoms

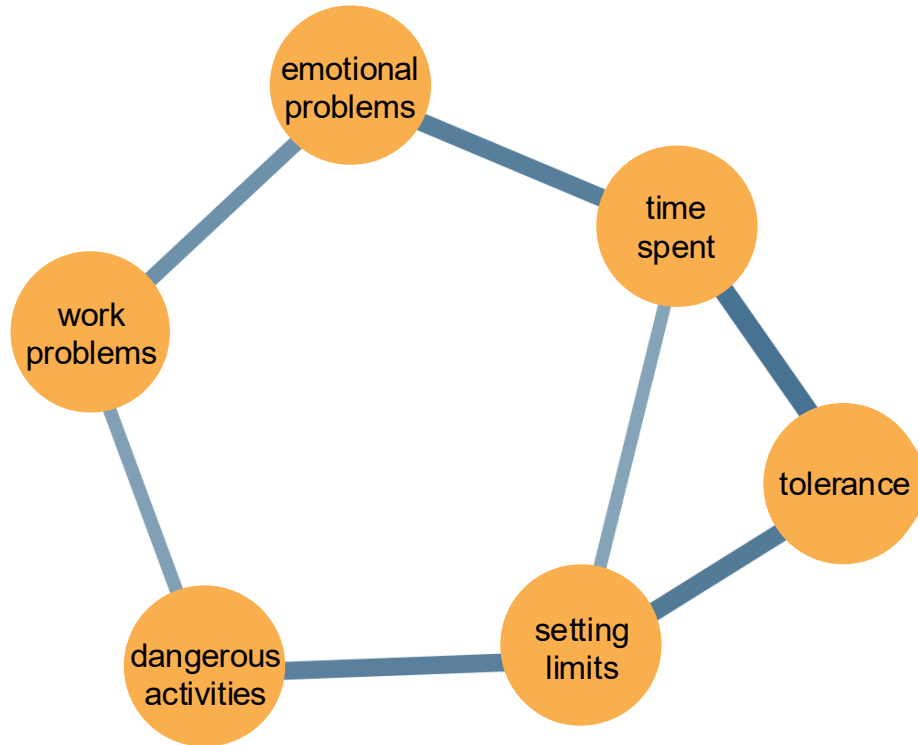


A network of alcohol disorder symptoms



Why is the edge missing?

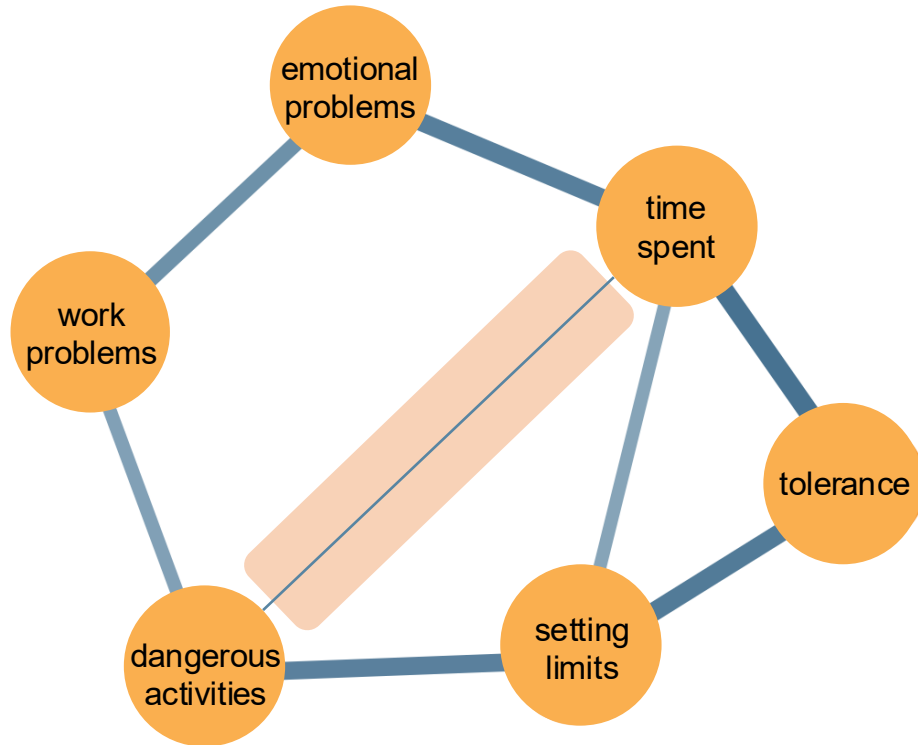
A network of alcohol disorder symptoms



Why is the edge missing?

Two possible explanations:

A network of alcohol disorder symptoms

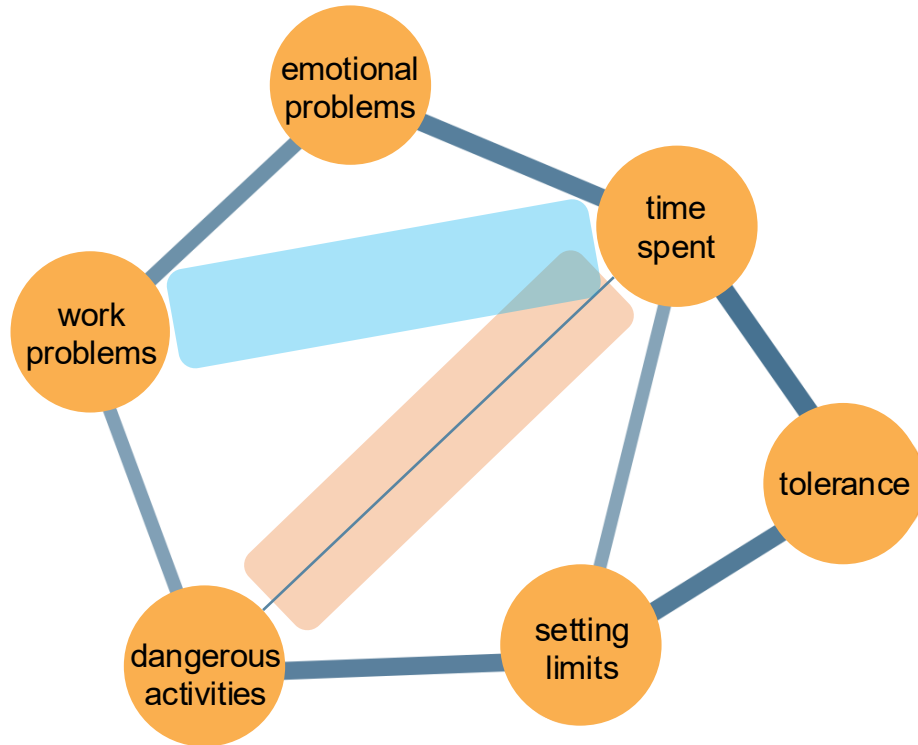


Why is the edge missing?

Two possible explanations:

1. Too little information.

A network of alcohol disorder symptoms

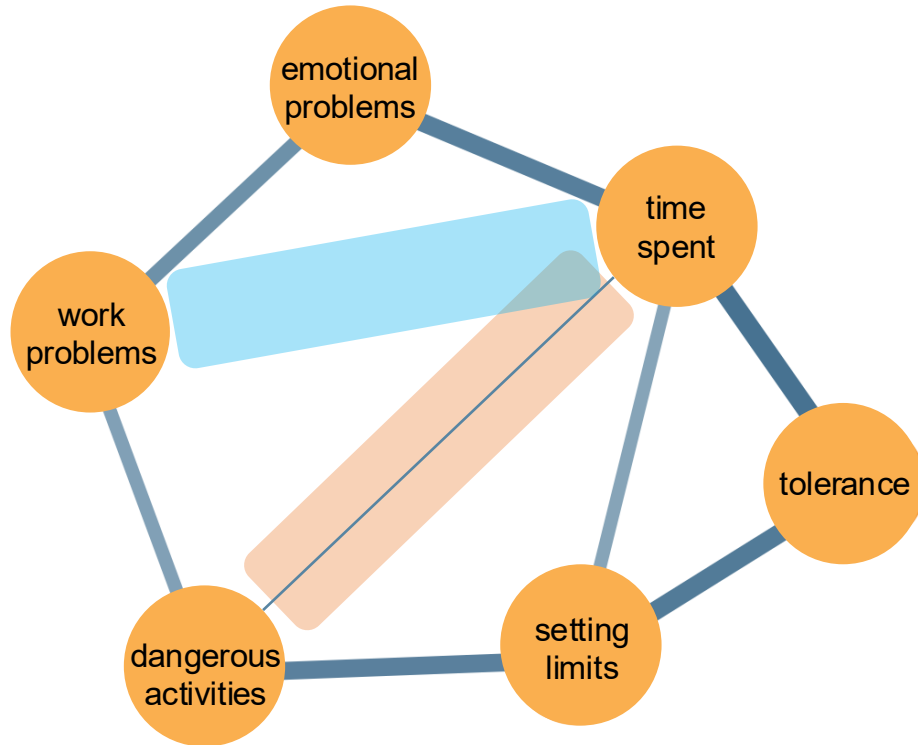


Why is the edge missing?

Two possible explanations:

1. Too little information.
2. True absence.

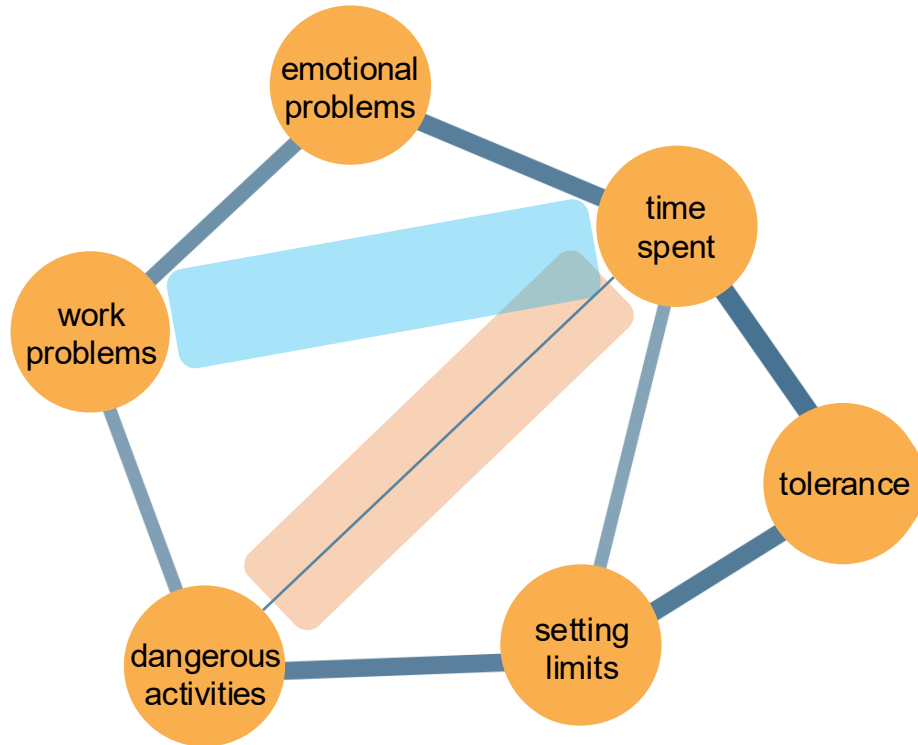
Two take-home messages



Network estimation is insufficient to determine whether an edge should be included or excluded.

Inclusion tests need to distinguish between **evidence of absence** and **absence of evidence**.

Two take-home messages



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Inclusion tests need to distinguish between **evidence of absence** and **absence of evidence**.

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

Evaluate the predictive success of the network structure.

$$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure})$$

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

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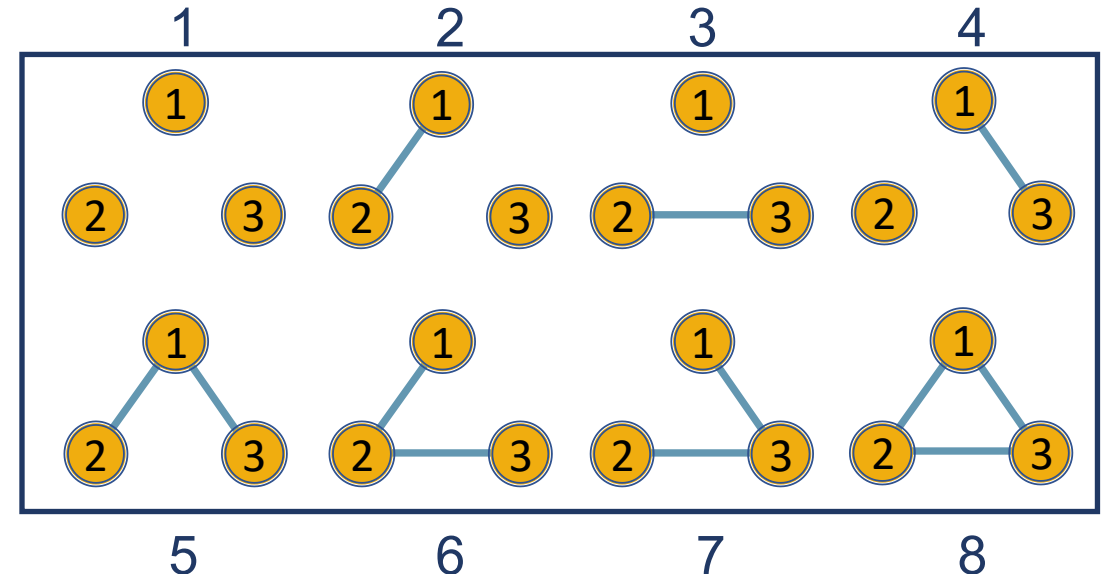
But which structure?

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

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But which structure?

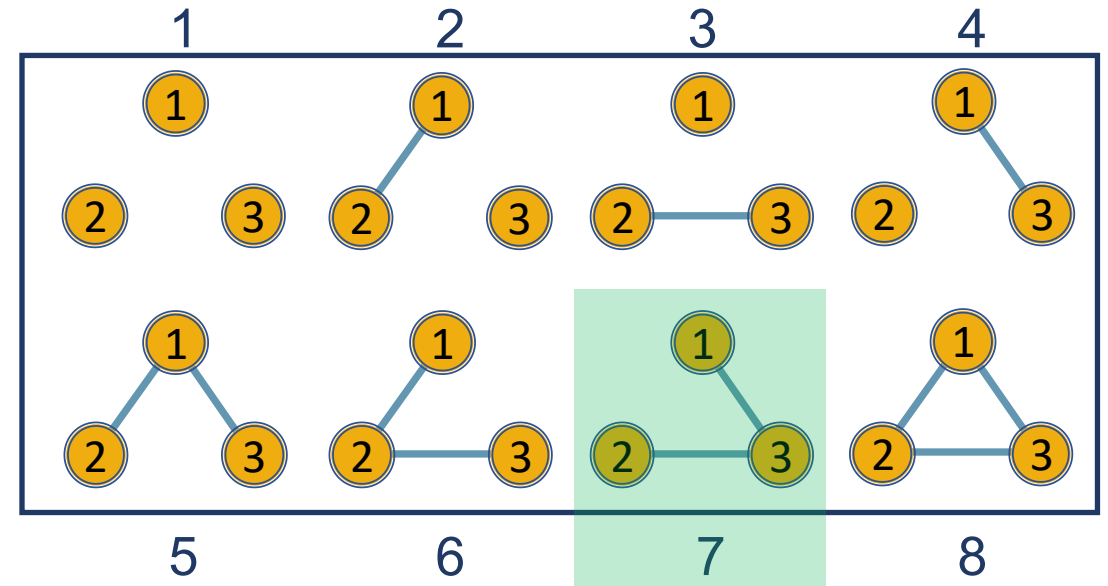


The Bayesian analysis of network structures

Evaluate the predictive success of the network structure.

$$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } 7)$$

But which structure?

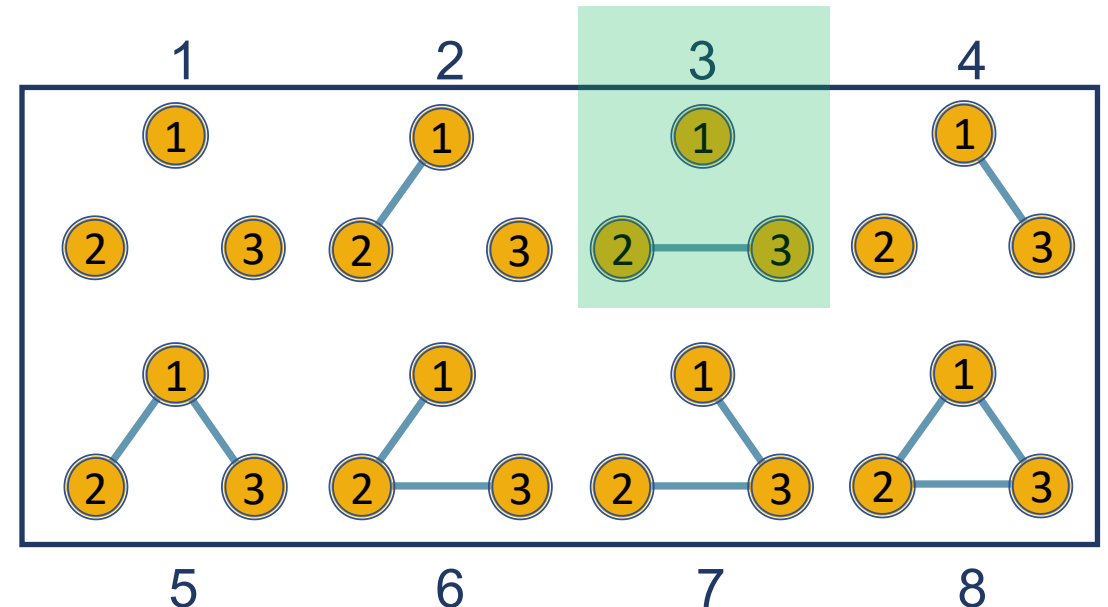


The Bayesian analysis of network structures

Evaluate the predictive success of the network structure.

$$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } 3)$$

But which structure?



The Bayesian analysis of network structures

Evaluate the predictive success of the network structure.

$$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } s)$$

We assign **prior** weights (probabilities) to the possible structures to reflect our uncertainty about the true structure.

$$P(\text{structure } s)$$

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

We use data to update our **prior** probabilities to **posterior** probabilities – what we know after having seen the data

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$$P(\text{structure 3} \mid \text{data}) = \frac{P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure 3}) P(\text{structure 3})}{P(\text{data})}$$

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

We use data to update our **prior** probabilities to **posterior** probabilities – what we know after having seen the data



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Predictive Updating Factor

The Bayesian analysis of network structures

We use data to update our **prior** probabilities to **posterior** probabilities – what we know after having seen the data



$$P(\text{structure } 3 \mid \text{data}) = \frac{P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } 3)P(\text{structure } 3)}{\sum_{s=1}^8 P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } s)P(\text{structure } s)}$$

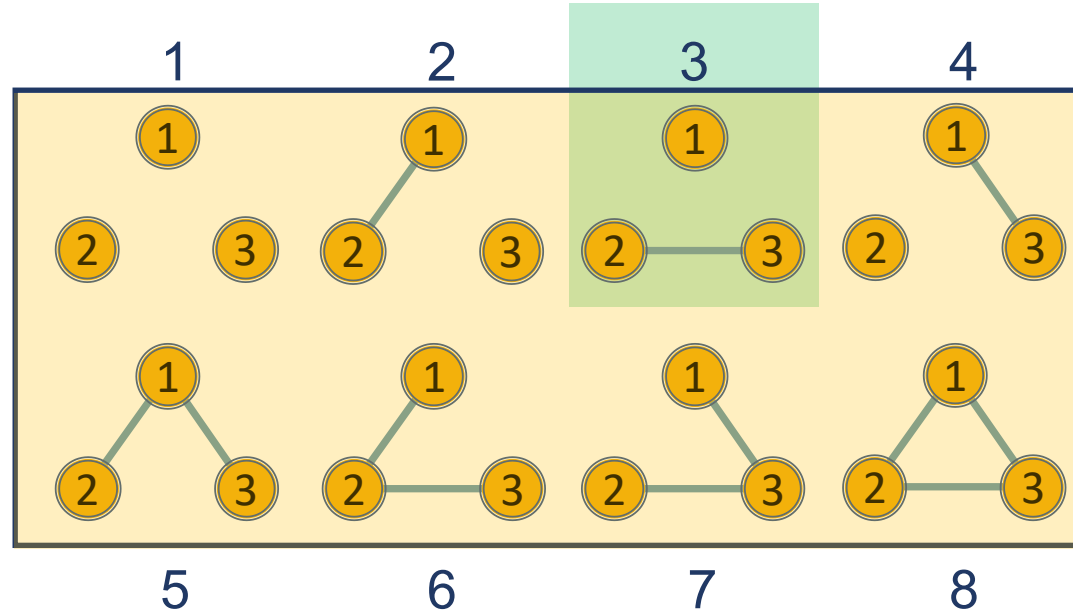
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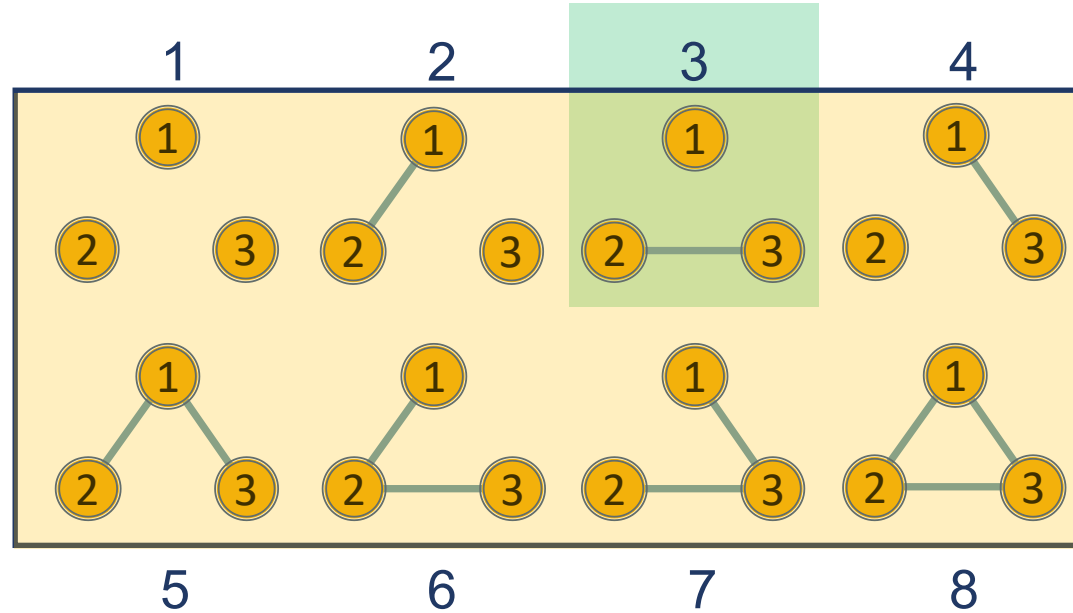
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The **prior** structure probabilities



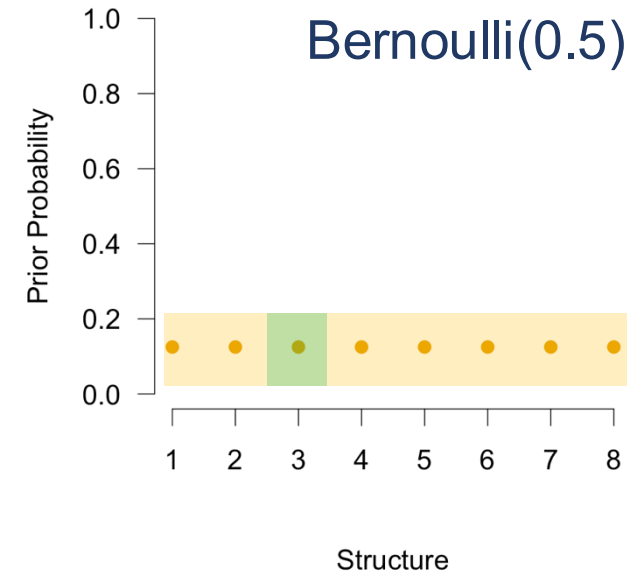
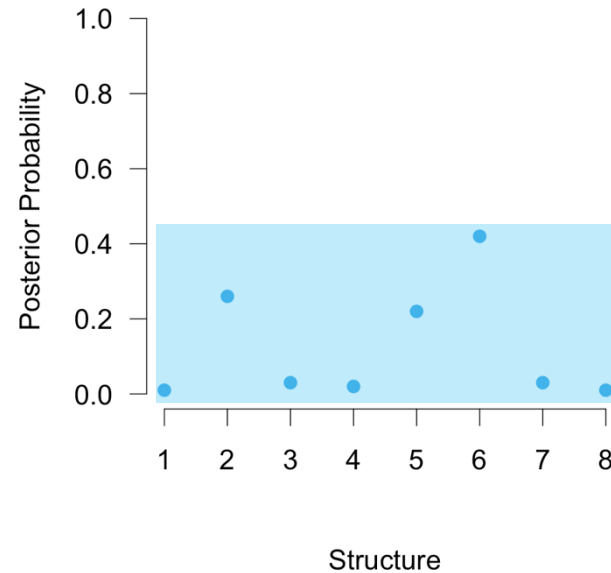
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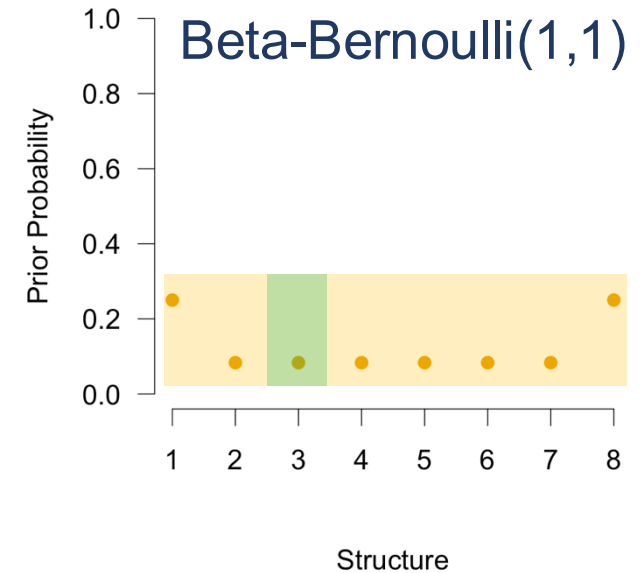
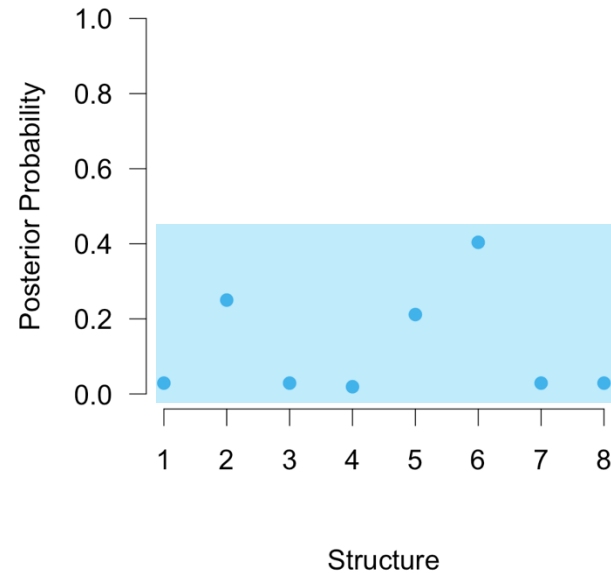
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The **prior** structure probabilities



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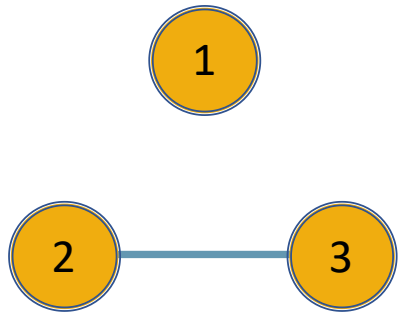


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The marginal likelihood

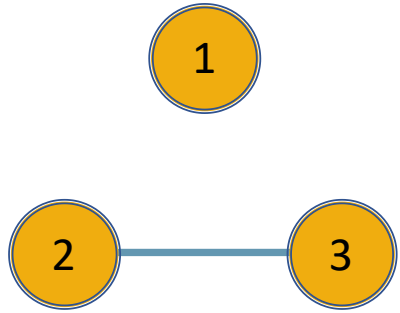
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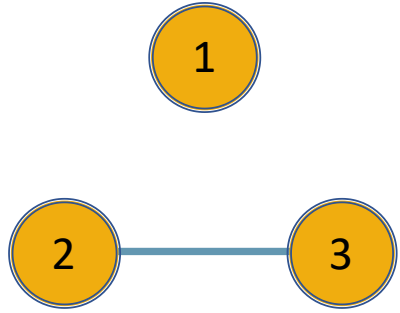
The marginal likelihood



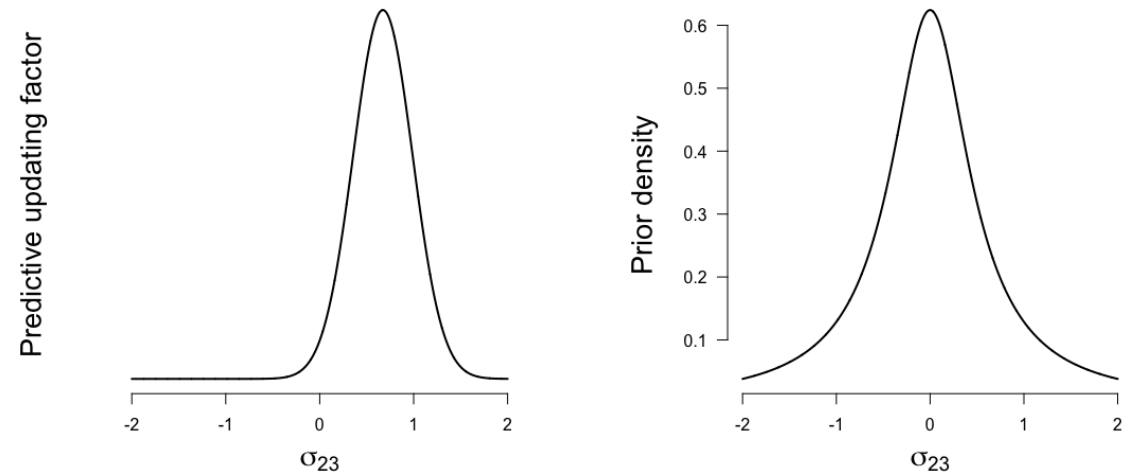
$$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } 3) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} p(\text{data} \mid \sigma_{23}) p(\sigma_{23}) d\sigma_{23}$$

$$P(\text{structure } 3 \mid \text{data}) = \frac{P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } 3)^{\frac{1}{8}}}{\sum_{s=1}^8 P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure } s)^{\frac{1}{8}}}$$

The marginal likelihood



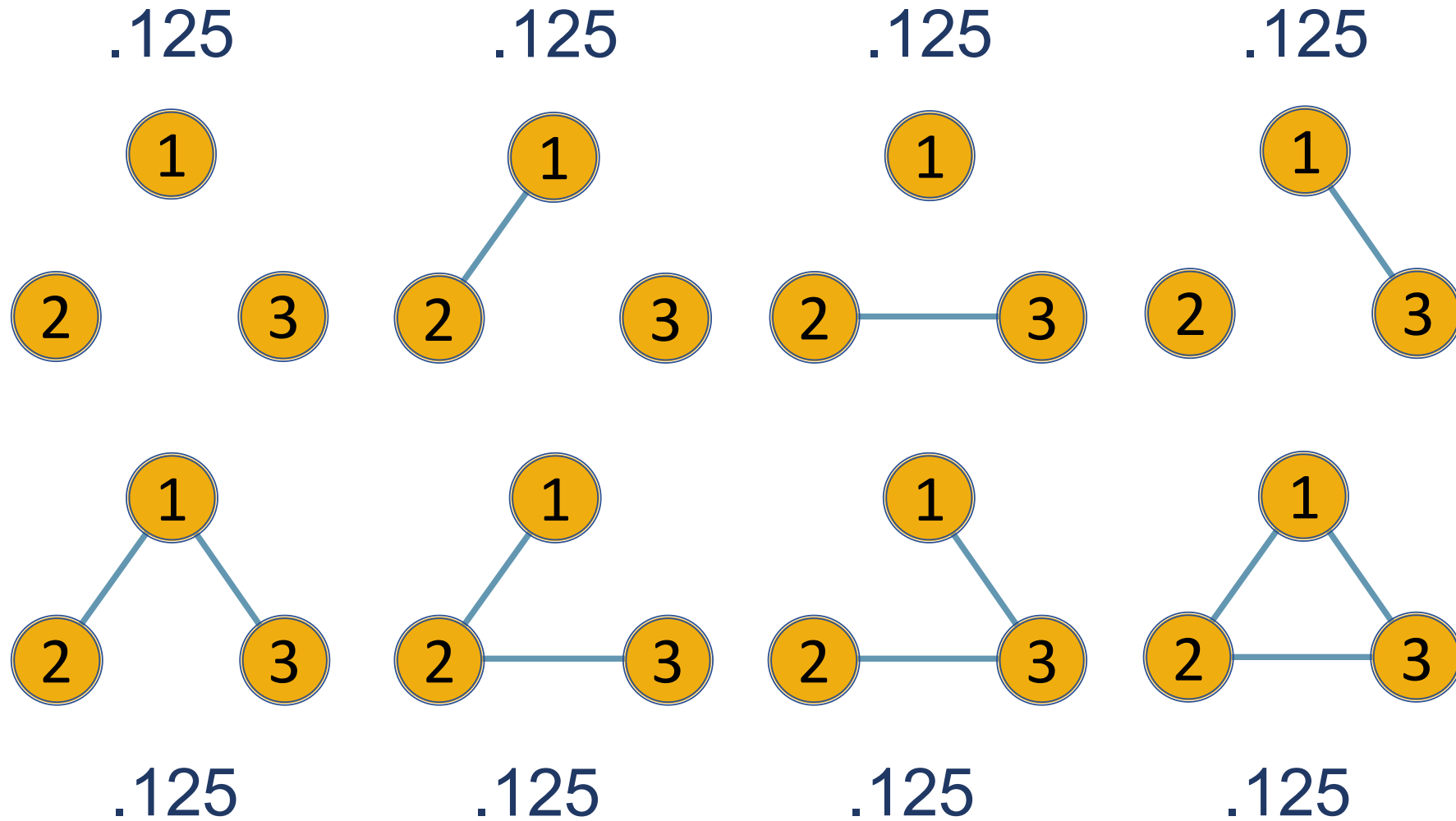
$P(\text{data} \mid \text{structure 3})$



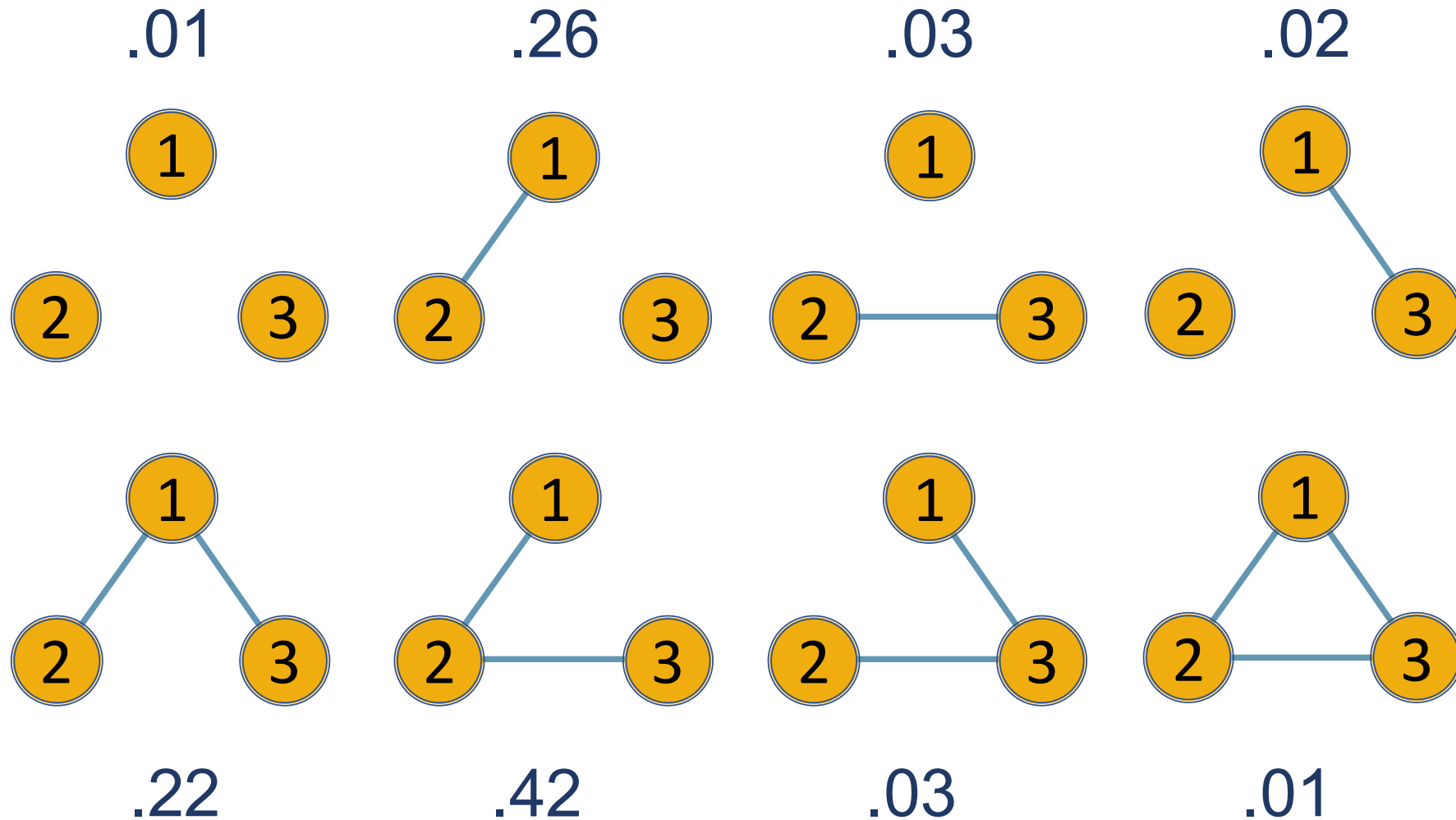
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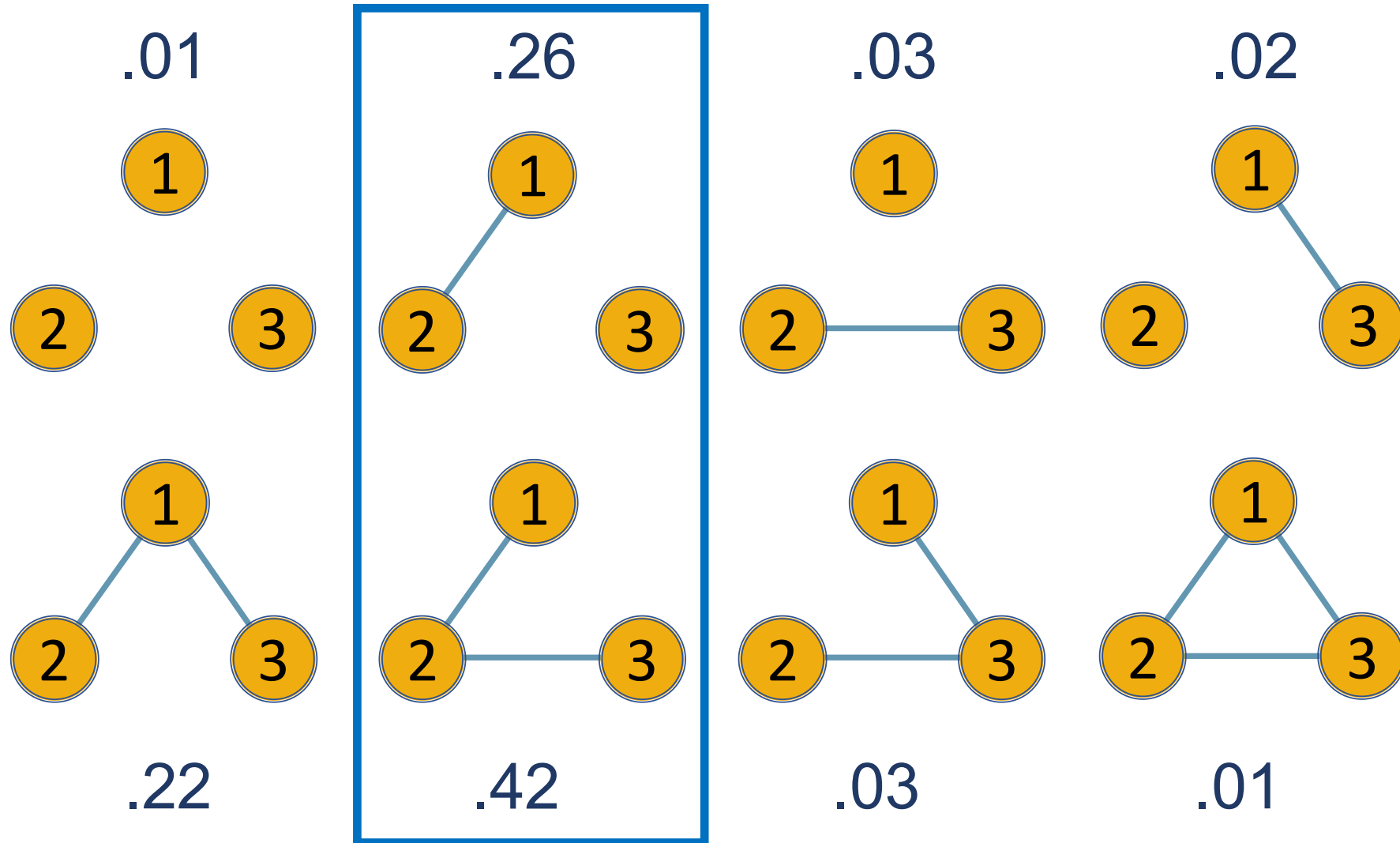
Bayesian estimation: **prior** probabilities



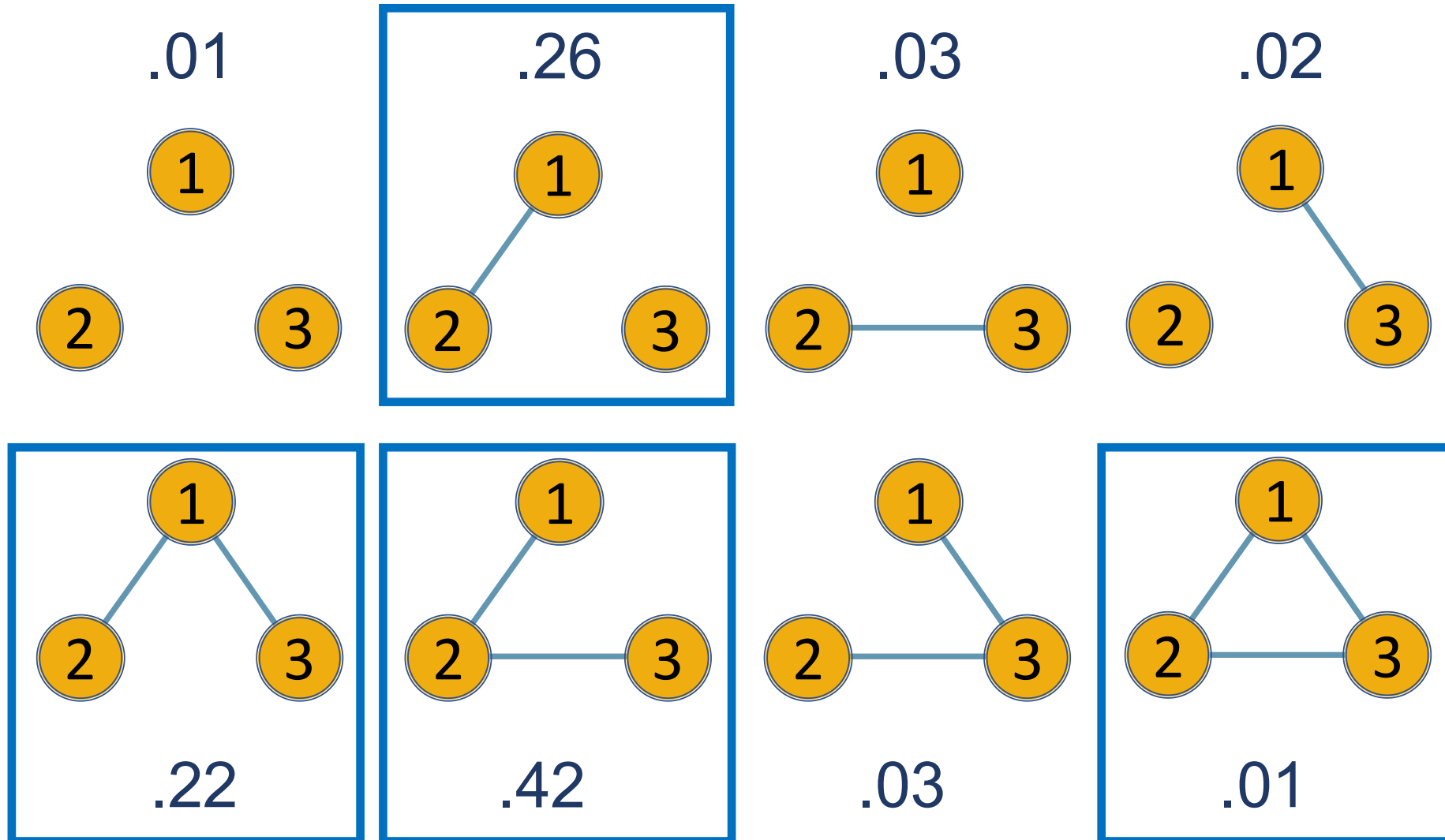
Bayesian estimation: **posterior** probabilities



Bayesian estimation: **posterior** probabilities



Bayesian estimation: **posterior** probabilities



Bayesian hypothesis testing

$\mathcal{H}_0$: There is no edge between variables 1 and 2

$\mathcal{H}_1$: There is an edge between variables 1 and 2

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$\mathcal{H}_1$: There is an edge between variables 1 and 2

$$\underbrace{\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data})}{P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data})}}_{\text{Posterior odds}} = \underbrace{\text{BF}_{10}}_{\text{Bayes factor}} \times \underbrace{\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1)}{P(\mathcal{H}_0)}}_{\text{Prior odds}}$$

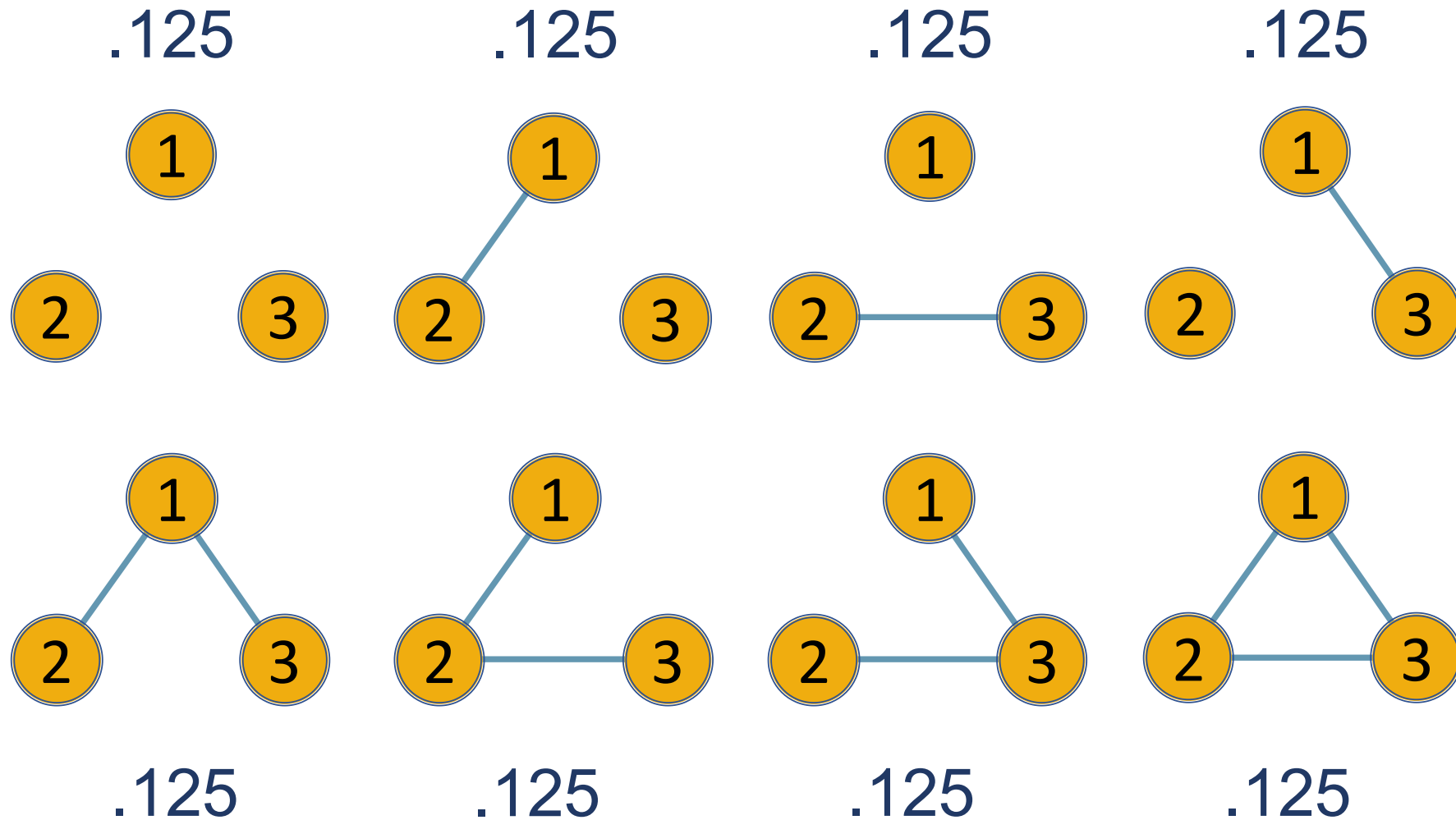
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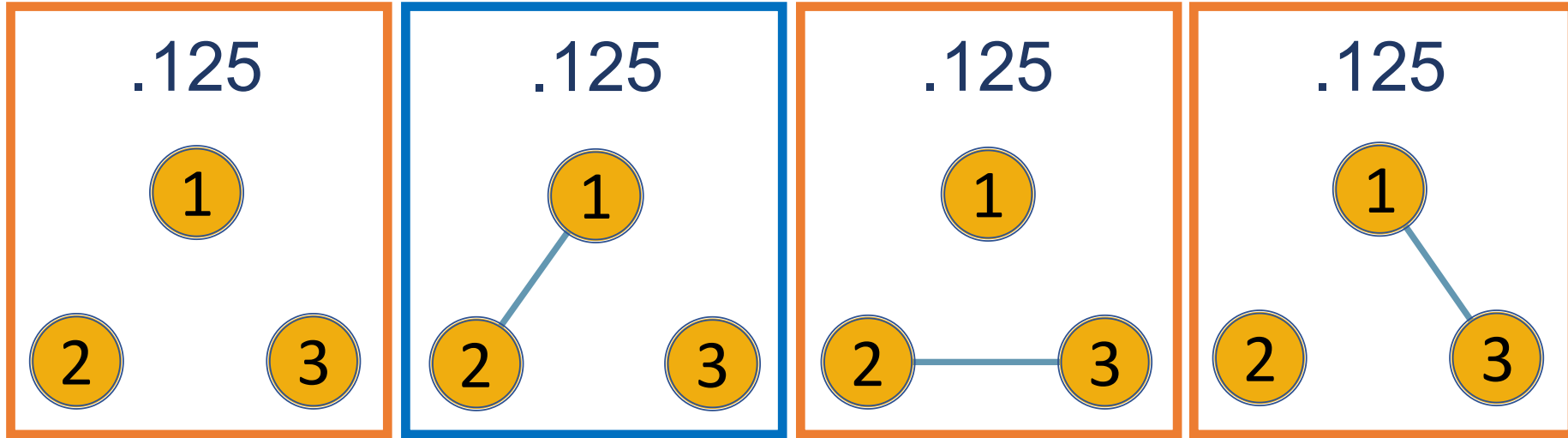
$$\underbrace{\text{BF}_{10}}_{\text{Bayes factor}} = \underbrace{\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data})}{P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data})}}_{\text{Posterior odds}} \bigg/ \underbrace{\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1)}{P(\mathcal{H}_0)}}_{\text{Prior odds}}$$

Bayesian hypothesis testing: **prior odds**

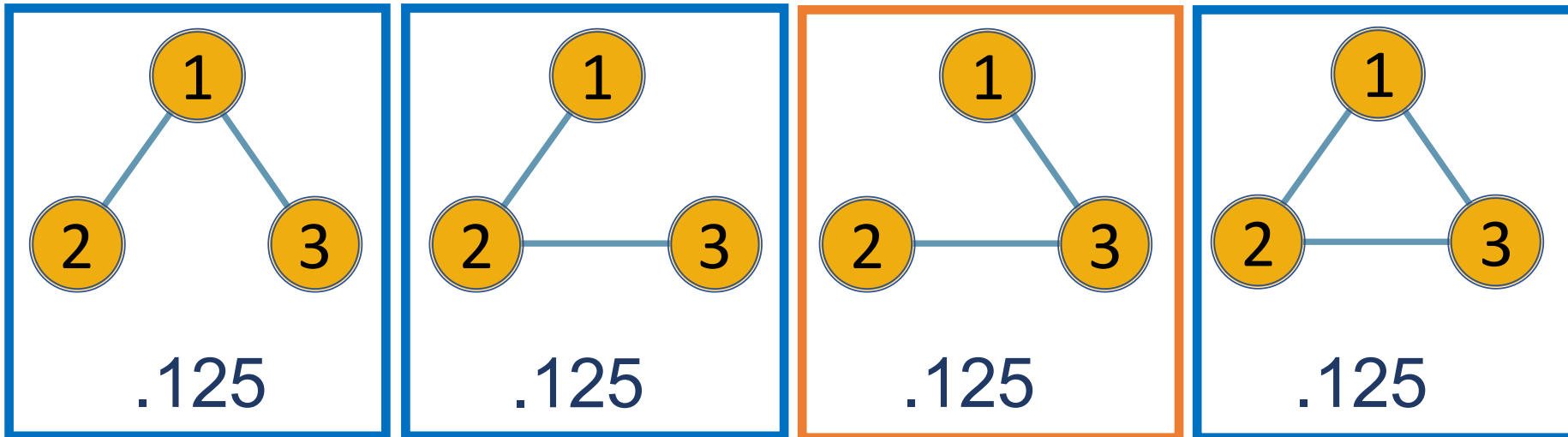


Bayesian hypothesis testing: **prior odds**

$\mathcal{H}_0$



$\mathcal{H}_1$



Bayesian hypothesis testing: **prior odds**

.125

.125

.125

.125

$$p(\mathcal{H}_0) = .125 + .125 + .125 + .125 = .5$$

$$p(\mathcal{H}_1) = .125 + .125 + .125 + .125 = .5$$

.125

.125

.125

.125

Bayesian hypothesis testing: **prior odds**

.125

.125

.125

.125

$$P(\mathcal{H}_0) = .5$$

$$P(\mathcal{H}_1) = .5$$

$$\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1)}{P(\mathcal{H}_0)} = 1$$

.125

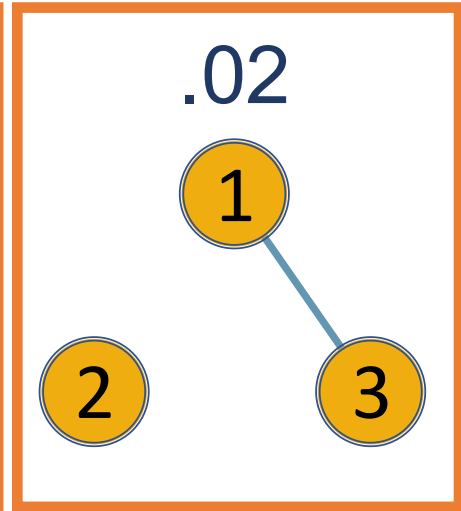
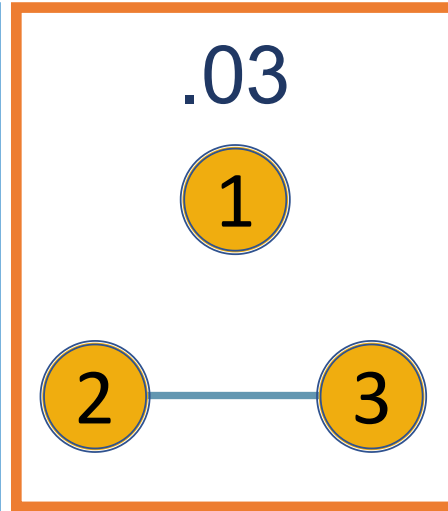
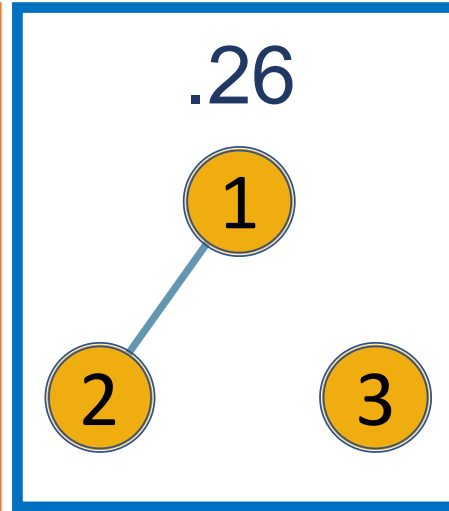
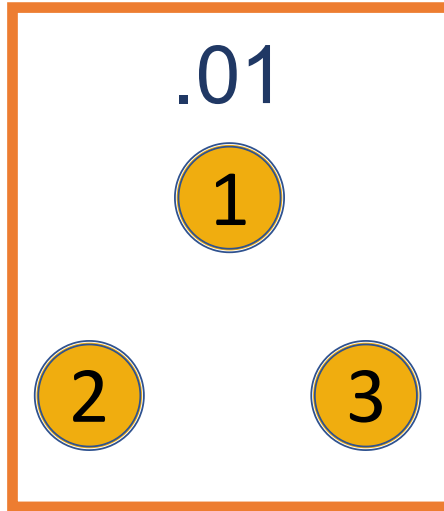
.125

.125

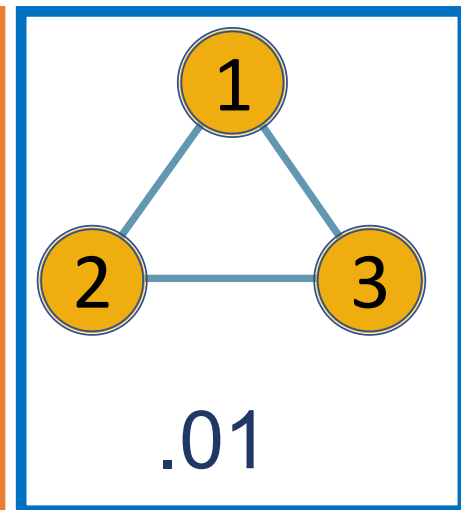
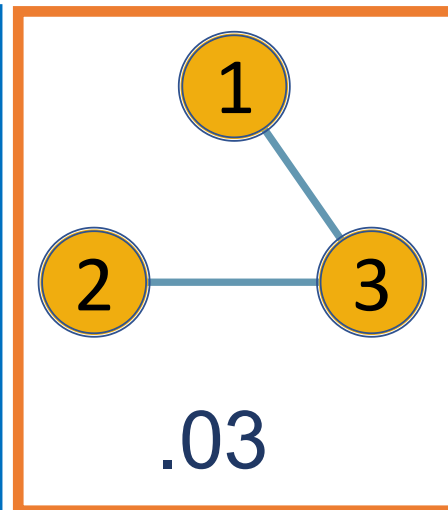
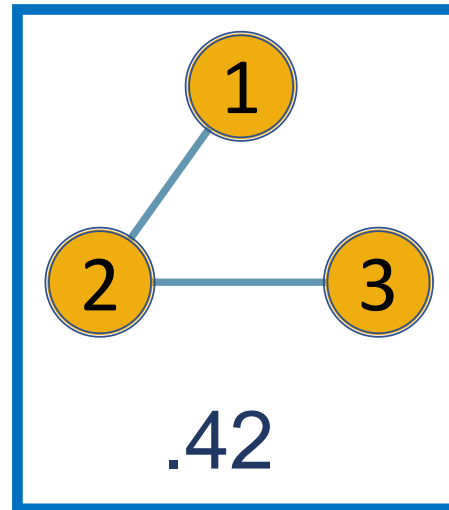
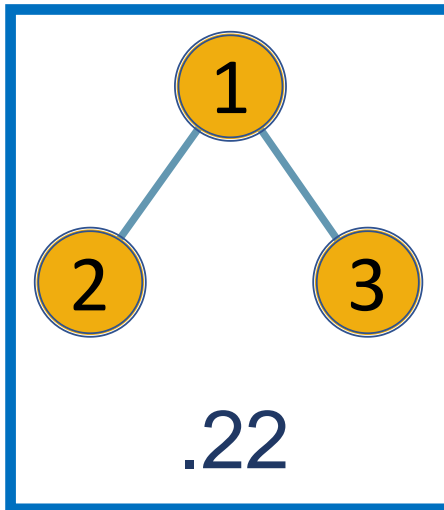
.125

Bayesian hypothesis testing: **posterior odds**

$\mathcal{H}_0$



$\mathcal{H}_1$



Bayesian hypothesis testing: **posterior odds**

.01

.26

.03

.02

$\mathcal{H}_0$

$$P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data}) = .01 + .03 + .02 + .03 = .09$$

$\mathcal{H}_1$

$$P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data}) = .26 + .22 + .42 + .01 = .91$$

.22

.42

.03

.01

Bayesian hypothesis testing: **posterior odds**

.01

.26

.03

.02

$$P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data}) = .09$$

$$P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data}) = .91$$

$$\frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data})}{P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data})} = \frac{.91}{.09} = 10.11$$

.22

.42

.03

.01

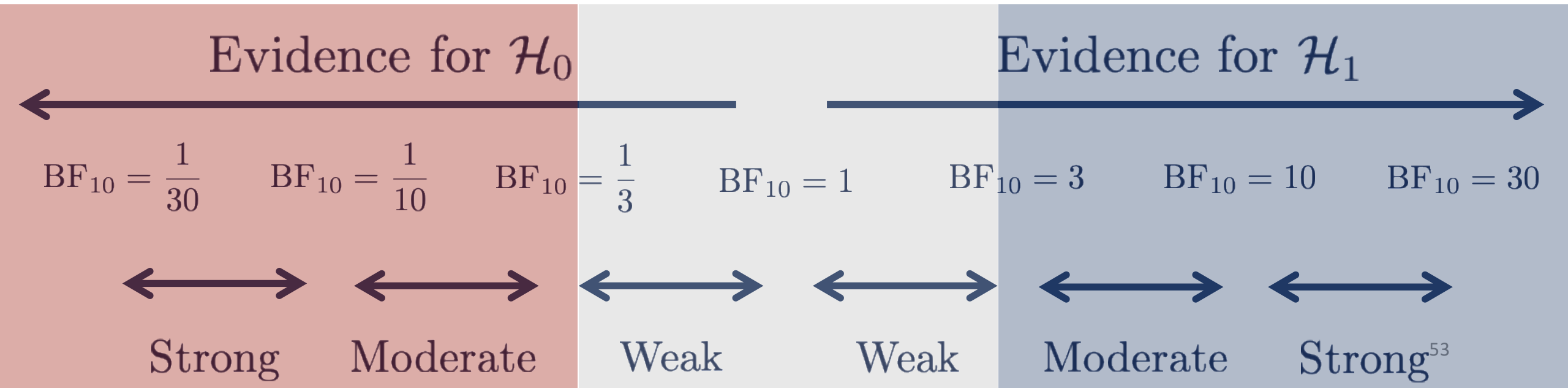
Bayesian hypothesis testing: **Bayes factor**

$$\text{BF}_{10} = \frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data})}{P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data})} \bigg/ \frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1)}{P(\mathcal{H}_0)} = 10.11$$

The data are 10.11 times more likely under structures that include an edge between variables 1 and 2!

Bayesian hypothesis testing: **Bayes factor**

$$\text{BF}_{10} = \frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1 \mid \text{data})}{P(\mathcal{H}_0 \mid \text{data})} \bigg/ \frac{P(\mathcal{H}_1)}{P(\mathcal{H}_0)} = 10.11$$

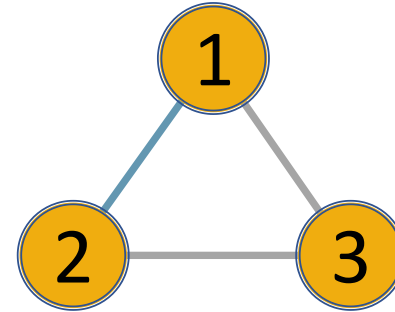


Bayesian hypothesis testing: Bayes factor

$$BF_{10}(1 - 2) = 10.11$$

$$BF_{10}(1 - 3) = 0.39$$

$$BF_{10}(2 - 3) = 0.96$$



Evidence for $\mathcal{H}_0$

Evidence for $\mathcal{H}_1$

$$BF_{10} = \frac{1}{30}$$

$$BF_{10} = \frac{1}{10}$$

$$BF_{10} = \frac{1}{3}$$

$$BF_{10} = 1$$

$$BF_{10} = 3$$

$$BF_{10} = 10$$

$$BF_{10} = 30$$



Strong

Moderate

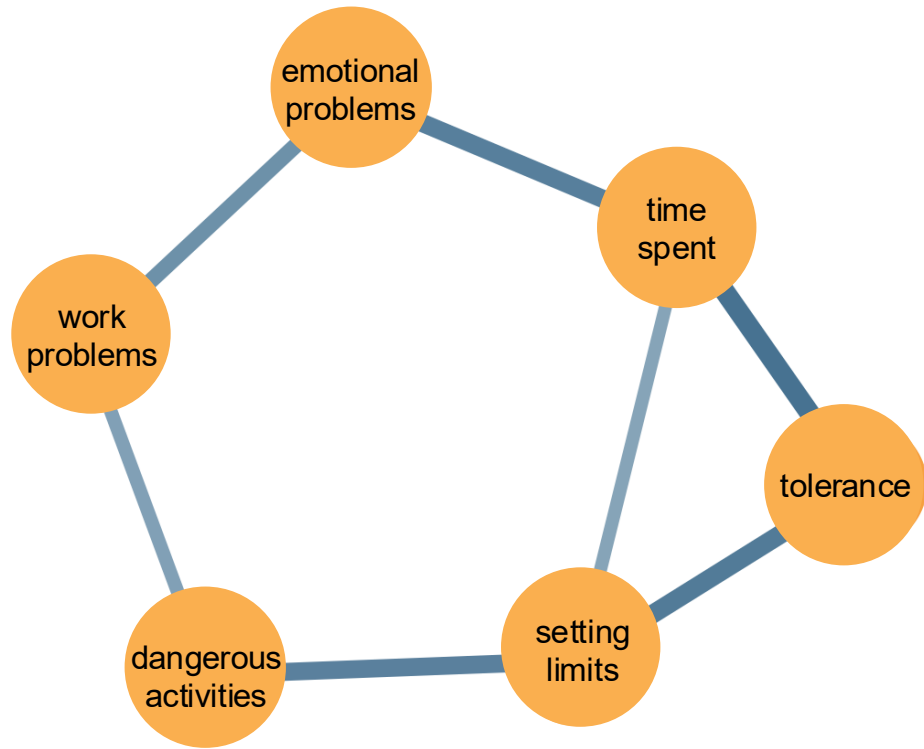
Weak

Weak

Moderate

Strong⁵⁴

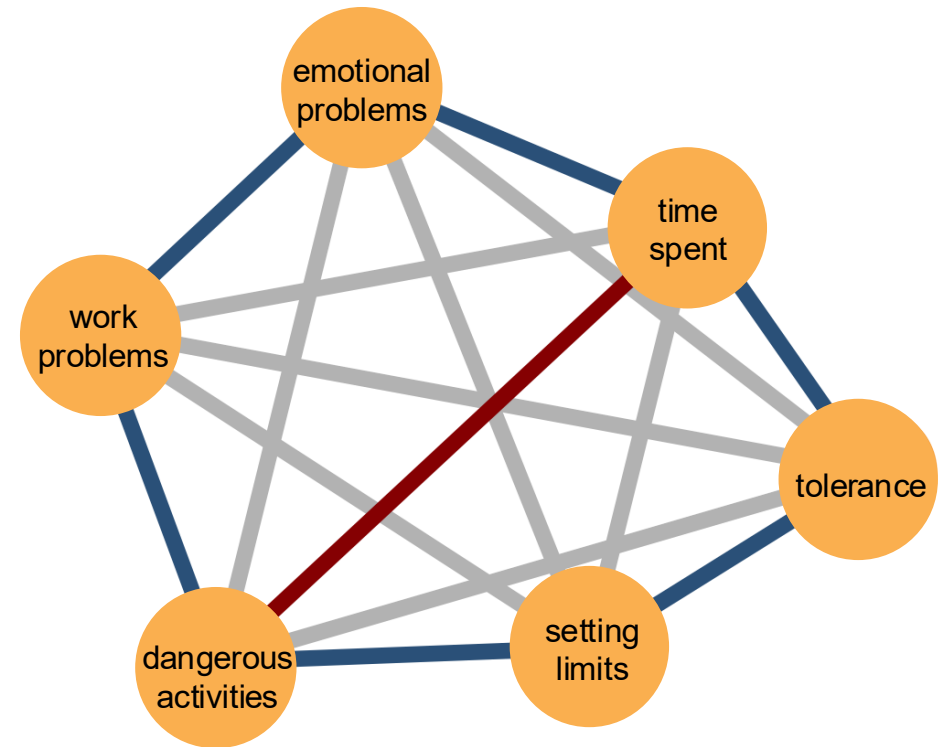
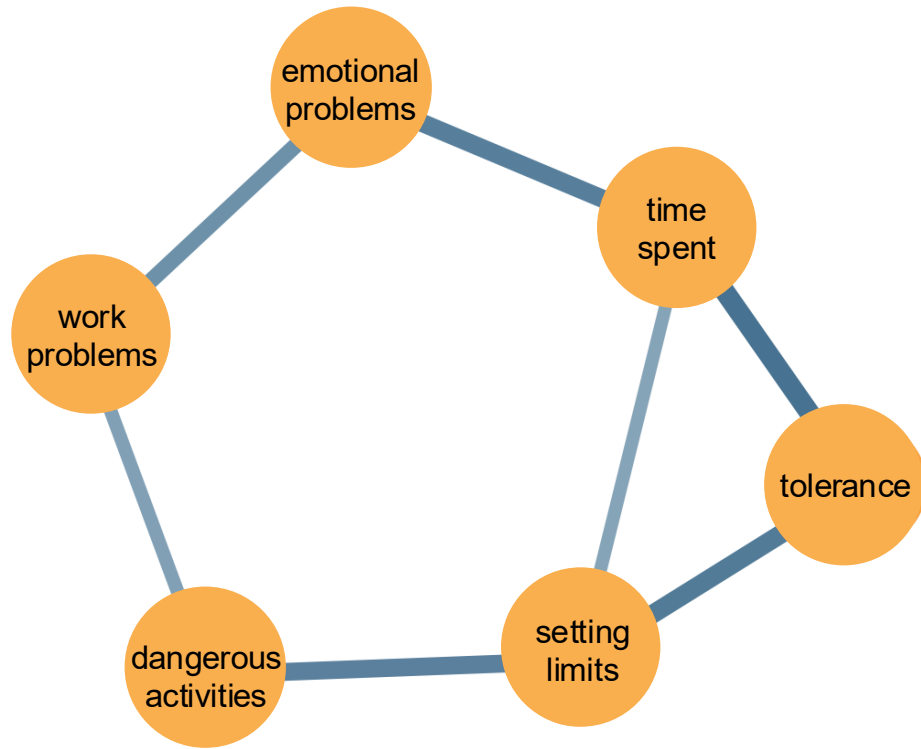
Quiz: Why are edges missing?



Solution: Evidence plot

Absence of evidence

Evidence of absence



Session setup



Part I: Theory



Part II: Practical



Part III: Project